

Phishing Email Analysis and IOC Extraction Report

Project: Phishing Email Analysis and IOC Extraction Workflow

Case Study: Your Account Is on Hold

Date: 24 June 2026

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Classification: Phishing Email

1. Executive Summary

This report analyzes a phishing email that impersonates Netflix by claiming the recipient's account has been suspended. The attacker attempts to create urgency using a fake billing notification while disguising the email as an official Netflix communication. The campaign relies on Sender Impersonation, brand impersonation, social engineering, and a Suspicious PDF attachment.

2. Scenario Overview

The phishing email claims that the recipient's Netflix account has been suspended due to a billing issue and requests immediate action to restore access. Instead of directing users to the official Netflix website, the attacker uses a suspicious attachment to hide the malicious payload and bypass traditional email security filters.

3. Phishing Techniques Identified

Sender impersonation

- The display name is **Netflix Billing**.
- The actual sender email belongs to an unrelated domain.
- The attacker impersonates Netflix to gain the recipient's trust.

Artificial Urgency

- The email claims that the Netflix account has been suspended.
- Users are pressured to act immediately to avoid losing account access.

Brand Impersonation

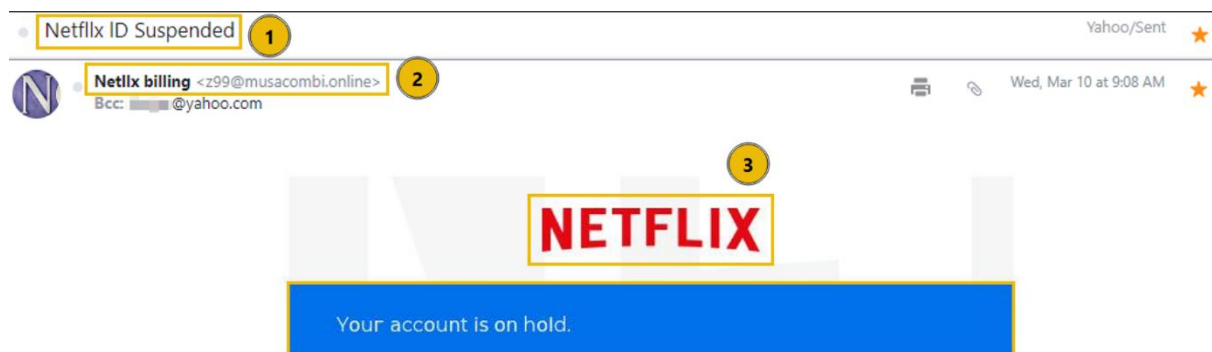
- The email uses Netflix logos, colours, and HTML formatting.
- These elements make the message appear authentic.

Poor Grammar and Typographical Errors

- Misspellings and grammatical mistakes are present.
- These errors are common indicators of phishing emails.

Malicious Attachment

- Instead of providing a direct login link, the attacker includes an attachment.
- The Suspicious PDF may contain malicious links or embedded content that could redirect the victim to a phishing or credential-harvesting page.



4. Indicators of Compromise (IOCs)

IOC Type	Value
Display Name	Netflix Billing
Brand Used	Netflix
Sender Domain	Suspicious / non-Netflix Domain
Email Subject	Netflix ID Suspended
Attack Category	Phishing
Delivery Method	Email Attachment
Social Engineering	Account Suspension Notification

The diagram illustrates a phishing email and its components. On the left, a screenshot of the email body is shown with annotations: a yellow box labeled '1' highlights the phone number '007-803-321-2130', and a yellow box labeled '2' highlights the 'Email Body' text. Below the email body is a PDF attachment icon labeled 'Payment-up...pdf' with a file size of '155.7KB'. On the right, a red box labeled 'Update Payment Account' is shown. Below it, text explains that if the user did not ask to reset their password, they may want to review their [recent account access](#) for any unusual activity. Further down, it says 'We're here to help if you need it. Visit the [Help Center](#) for more info or [contact us](#).' and 'Your friends at Netflix'. At the bottom right, a yellow box labeled 'PDF Attachment' is shown.

5. Analysis Findings

Subject Analysis

The subject line informs the recipient that their Netflix account has been suspended, creating urgency and encouraging immediate action.

Sender Analysis

Although the display name appears to represent Netflix, the underlying sender domain does not belong to Netflix, indicating sender impersonation.

Content Analysis

The email uses official Netflix branding and claims that billing issues have caused account suspension. This creates fear and pressures users into interacting with the email.

Attachment Analysis

The PDF attachment is suspicious and should be analyzed safely before opening. It may contain malicious links or embedded content that could redirect users to phishing websites or credential-harvesting pages.

6. Detection Opportunities

- Detect suspicious attachment types.
- Scan attachments in a sandbox.
- Alert on brand impersonation.

7. Risk Assessment

Risk Level: High

Severity: High

Confidence: High

Category: Phishing / Suspicious Attachment

Reasons

- Netflix brand impersonation
- Sender email mismatch
- Artificial urgency
- Suspicious attachment
- Poor grammar and typographical errors
- Potential malicious content or credential harvesting

8. MITRE ATT&CK Mapping

Technique ID : T1566.001

Technique Name : Phishing: Spearphishing Attachment

The attacker delivers a suspicious attachment through email to persuade the victim to open the file, potentially leading to credential theft or further malicious activity.

9. Recommended Actions

1. Do not open the attachment.
2. Verify account status through the official Netflix website.
3. Block the sender's email address and domain.
4. Scan suspicious attachments in a sandbox environment.
5. Report the email to the security team.
6. Enable Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) where supported.
7. Educate users about fake account suspension scams.

10. Conclusion

This email is a phishing attempt that impersonates Netflix to trick recipients into interacting with a suspicious attachment. Multiple phishing indicators—including sender impersonation, brand impersonation, urgency-based social engineering, suspicious attachment, and poor grammar—strongly indicate that the email should be classified as phishing and blocked.